



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Iraq. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

That's a great place to be—finishing primary school and looking ahead to your future! Since you're 16 and in Denmark, your next step usually involves choosing a **youth education program**. Denmark offers several good options depending on your interests, skills, and long-term goals. Here's a breakdown of the main educational paths and some personalized recommendations based on your background:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

These are academically focused and prepare you for university. There are a few types:

- **STX** (*Alment Gymnasium*): Broad and academic. Great if you're not yet sure what you want to study.
- **HHX** (*Handelsskole*): Focus on business, economics, and international trade.
- **HTX** (*Teknisk Gymnasium*): Focus on technology and science—ideal if you like subjects like physics, biology, or IT.
- **HF**: Shorter (2 years), often more practical. Suited for students who prefer more freedom or didn't follow the standard 9th-grade exams.

Recommended if:

You enjoy school, want to keep university as an option, and are good with reading, writing, and theory. STX or HHX could be strong choices for someone fluent in Danish with cultural insight into both Danish and Iraqi life—you could later go into law, international studies, business, or social sciences.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training - VET)

These combine school with practical training (apprenticeships). Examples:

- Carpenter, electrician, mechanic
- Hairdresser, chef, healthcare worker
- IT support, data technician

Recommended if:

You want to start working sooner, like hands-on learning, or are interested in a specific skill or trade. These are often underappreciated but very solid and respected paths in Denmark—with good salaries and job security.

3. Kombinerede forløb (EUX)

This combines vocational training with academic subjects. You get both a vocational qualification and a diploma that allows you to apply to university.

● **Recommended if:**

You want a good mix of theory and practice and want to keep your options open. It's demanding, but perfect for motivated students who aren't sure yet whether they want university or to go straight into work.

Your Background and Strengths

You're bilingual and bicultural, which is a **huge strength** in today's globalized world. That opens doors in:

- **International business**
- **Translation/interpretation**
- **Law or diplomacy**
- **Social work or teaching**
- **Technology and innovation**

My Advice

Here are a few ways you can approach your decision:

If you like school and are curious about university:

👉 **Choose STX or HHX**

If you like doing things with your hands or want to work sooner:

👉 **Choose EUD (vocational training)**

If you want both options open (work or study later):

👉 **Choose EUX**

Final Tips

- **Visit open house events** at your local schools.
- **Talk to a guidance counselor** (studievejleder).
- Think about what **motivates you**—money, helping people, creating things, solving problems, etc.
- Ask older friends or family members about their experiences.

If you want, I can help you explore specific schools near your area or give you a few examples of study paths based on what you're interested in. Would you like that?